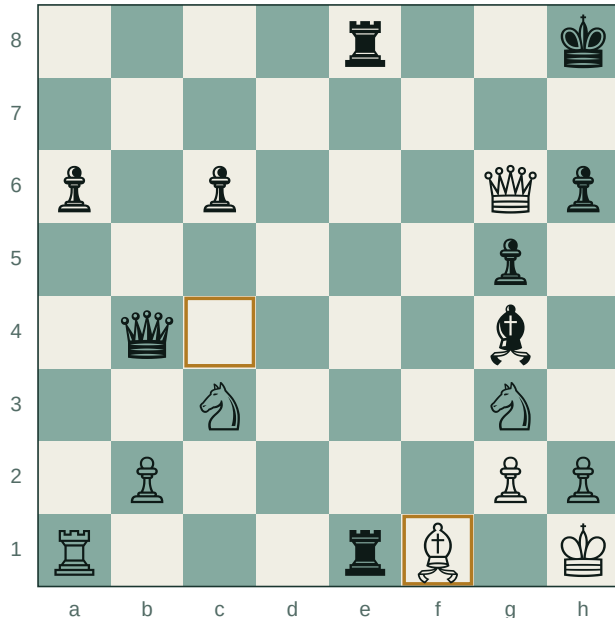


Pins and pressure: Black, move 31

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Bf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...R8e6 32. Rxe1 Rxc6

31...R8e6 The rook moves from e8 to e6. Recorded reply: **32.Rxe1**.

32...Rxc6 The rook captures the queen on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: bishop on f1.